

Daily Bible Note

Date: July 1, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Psalm 107:1-22

1 Oh, give thanks to the Lord, for He is good! For His mercy endures forever.

2 Let the redeemed of the Lord say so, Whom He has redeemed from the hand of the enemy,

3 And gathered out of the lands, From the east and from the west, From the north and from the south.

4 They wandered in the wilderness in a desolate way; They found no city to dwell in.

5 Hungry and thirsty, Their soul fainted in them.

6 Then they cried out to the Lord in their trouble, And He delivered them out of their distresses.

7 And He led them forth by the right way, That they might go to a city for a dwelling place.

8 Oh, that men would give thanks to the Lord for His goodness, And for His wonderful works to the children of men!

9 For He satisfies the longing soul, And fills the hungry soul with goodness.

10 Those who sat in darkness and in the shadow of death, Bound in affliction and irons—

11 Because they rebelled against the words of God, And despised the counsel of the Most High,

12 Therefore He brought down their heart with labor; They fell down, and there was none to help.

13 Then they cried out to the Lord in their trouble, And He saved them out of their distresses.

14 He brought them out of darkness and the shadow of death, And broke their chains in pieces.

15 Oh, that men would give thanks to the Lord for His goodness, And for His wonderful works to the children of men!

16 For He has broken the gates of bronze, And cut the bars of iron in two.

17 Fools, because of their transgression, And because of their iniquities, were afflicted.

18 Their soul abhorred all manner of food, And they drew near to the gates of death.

19 Then they cried out to the Lord in their trouble, And He saved them out of their distresses.

20 He sent His word and healed them, And delivered them from their destructions.

21 Oh, that men would give thanks to the Lord for His goodness, And for His wonderful works to the children of men!

22 Let them sacrifice the sacrifices of thanksgiving, And declare His works with rejoicing.

II. Key Summary

- The psalm opens with a call for all the Lord's redeemed to give thanks, declaring that God is good and His mercy endures forever (vv. 1–3)
 - Three distinct groups — those lost in the wilderness (vv. 4–9), those bound in darkness and chains (vv. 10–16), and those brought near death by their own wrongdoing (vv. 17–22) — each cry out to God and receive deliverance
 - After each scene of rescue, the same refrain calls everyone to praise God for His goodness (vv. 8, 15, 21), culminating in an invitation to offer sacrifices of thanksgiving (v. 22)
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III. Passage Analysis

Different Plights, One Same Turning Point

"Consider the successive vignettes of this psalm. Love broods over the weary caravan that faints in the desert; visits the prison-house with its captives; watches by our beds of pain; notices each lurch of the tempest-driven vessel; brings the weary hosts from the wilderness into the fruitful soil." [1]

Three completely different stories — wandering, imprisoned, sick — yet every single one ends the same way: they cried out to the Lord, and He answered. Psalm 107 shows that no matter how different our situations look on the outside, the move that changes everything is always the same: reaching out to God.

God's Steadfast Love Has No Beginning and No End

"That mercy had no beginning, and shall never know an end." [2]

The Hebrew word *hesed* in verse 1 — translated "mercy" or "steadfast love" — is the foundation everything else in this psalm rests on. It's not just something God does; it's who He is. Every rescue scene in this passage is *hesed* in action — the same faithful love showing up, again and again, in a different face.

IV. Reflection Question

Is there anything in your life right now that makes it hard to say "thank you" to God?

In Psalm 107, every person's situation is extremely difficult — but in the end, they are all called to do the same thing: give thanks to the Lord, for His mercy endures forever.

References

[1] Enduring Word, David Guzik (quoting F.B. Meyer),
<https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/psalm-107/>

[2] BibleHub Commentaries, Charles Spurgeon (Treasury of David),
<https://www.biblehub.com/commentaries/psalms/107-1.htm>